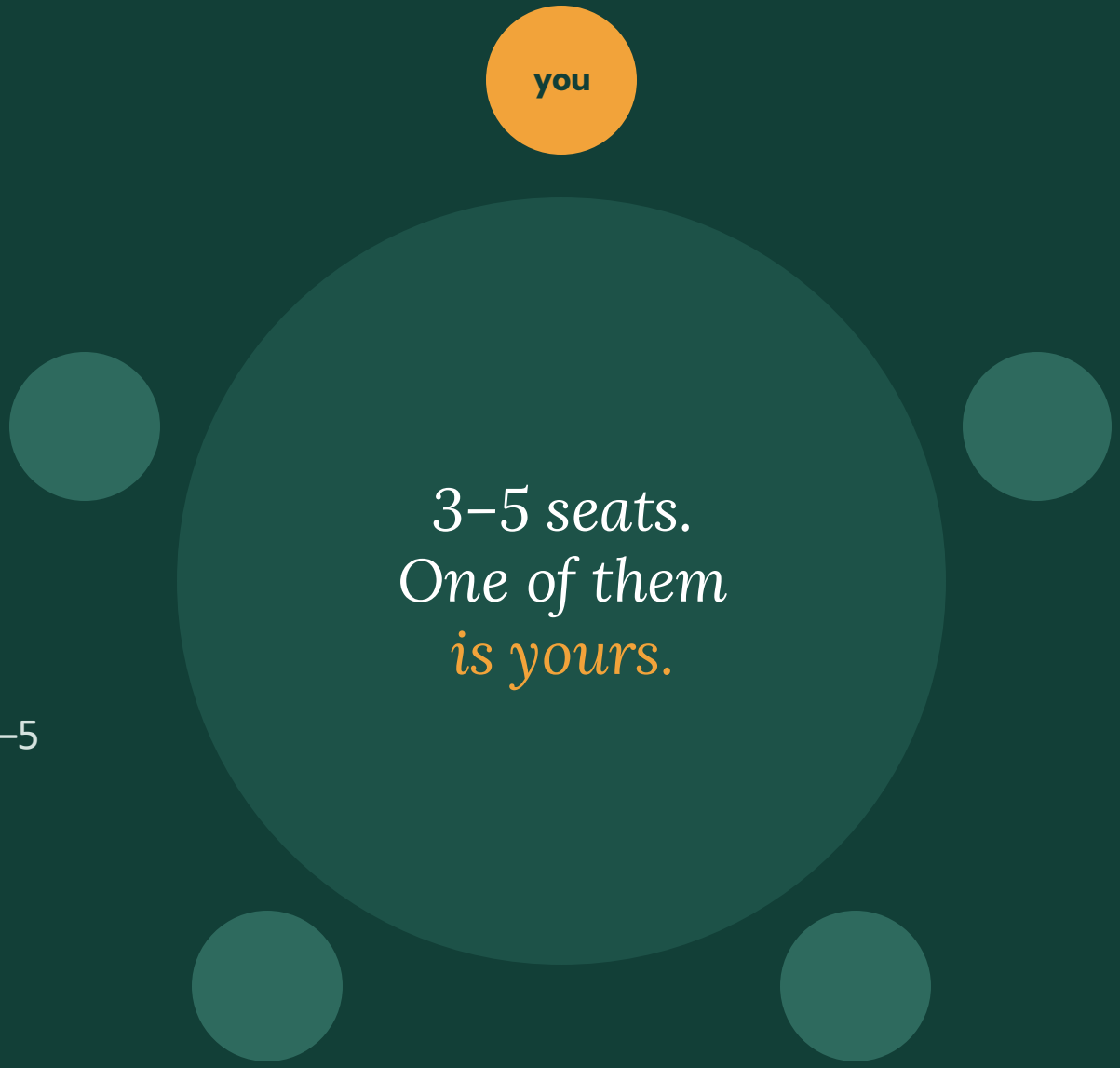
PM101 · FINAL PROJECT

Table for One

but not alone.

An AI gets to know you first, then seats you with the right 3–5 people.



Combating loneliness in an increasingly digital world

Team: [Name 1] · [Name 2] · [Name 3] · [Name 4] · [Name 5] · [Name 6] · [Name 7]

Lonely in a crowded city

1 in 6

people worldwide are affected by loneliness, linked to ~871,000 deaths a year

WHO Commission on Social Connection, 2025

43%

of urban Indians say they feel lonely most of most of the time

Ipsos Global Survey, 2021

+23%

growth in restaurant reservations for one, in a single year

OpenTable data via Axios, Jul 2026

The insight *People already eat alone. A meal is the most frequent social moment we let slip.*



Photo · Matt W Newman / Unsplash

02 PERSONA + JOBS TO BE DONE

Meet Ananya, 24

Analyst · moved from Kolkata to Gurugram for her first job

When I'm new in a city and free for dinner, I want to share a good meal with a few like-minded people, so I can feel I belong here without forcing it.

Today

- Eats out 3–4 times a week, mostly alone
- Her friends are colleagues and WhatsApp groups back home

Pains

- Walking in alone feels awkward
- Meetups feel like networking
- Friend apps mean endless chat, no plan

Functional a plan and a table

Emotional feeling she belongs

Social not 'the one eating alone'

From insight to a testable bet

1

Opportunity

Turn solo meals into small tables of people who genuinely click, with no networking and no forced introductions.

2

Hypothesis

If an AI chat gets to know people first and seats 3–5 only only when the fit is strong, 40% of first-timers book again again within 30 days.

3

Riskiest assumption

Will people open up to an AI, AI, wait for the right table, and and still show up?

4

Cheapest test

Wizard-of-Oz pilot: our team team runs the 'AI' chats on WhatsApp and matches by by hand. 3 partner cafés, 10 10 tables.

How we validate 15 interviews about past behaviour ("Tell me about the last time you ate alone") + a 100-person survey of young professionals. professionals.

Vision

No one in a new city should eat alone unless they want to.

Where to play

22–32-year-old professionals who moved to a Tier-1 city. Gurugram first.

How we win

An AI conversation gets to know you first; we seat you seat you only when the right people exist. Food is the is the reason to meet.

What we won't do

No dating, no large events, no social feed.

Where we play and how we win

The competitive set: who else helps people meet over food?

	Who you meet	When	Gap we fill
Timeleft	6 strangers, picked for you	Fixed weekly night	Short quiz, same night for everyone
Meetup	Interest groups	Event-led	Big rooms, little conversation
Bumble BFF	1:1 swipe and chat	If chat becomes a plan	Chat fatigue, rarely meets
Dineout / Zomato	Nobody new	Any time	Books a table, not people
Table for One	**3–5 people our AI picked after talking to you**	**When the right table exists**	**Fit over frequency**

Sources: timeleft.com (300+ cities, weekly dinners of 6) · The Week, Sep 2025 (Timeleft in Delhi NCR) · company websites

Photo · Spencer Davis / Unsplash

The experience

1

Talk

A 10-minute chat with our AI about what you love and what you could talk about for hours

2

Set

Your free windows, area, budget and veg / non-veg

3

Wait

The AI waits for the right people: days or weeks, not not every Wednesday

4

Meet

Your table of 3–5, the restaurant, and an icebreaker icebreaker built on what you you share

5

Reflect

Rate the table; the AI learns; learns; tap 'eat again with' to to become regulars

Information architecture (LATCH) your profile is organised by Location (area), Time (free windows) and Category (cuisine).

What we build first

Must

AI onboarding chat, matching matching 3–5, restaurant booking, phone + ID check, check, women-only tables

Should

Icebreaker cards, post-rating

Could

UPI bill split, 'eat again' regulars

Won't (now)

Chat feed, dating, events 6 people

Feature	Reach	Impact	Conf.	Effort	RICE
Icebreaker cards	800	1	60%	0.25	**1,920**
Phone + ID verification	1,000	2	90%	1	**1,800**
Women-only tables	500	2	70%	0.5	**1,400**
Matching engine (v1)	1,000	3	80%	2	**1,200**
AI conversation analyst	1,000	3	50%	3	**500**
UPI bill split	800	0.5	70%	1.5	**187**

Reach = users per month in pilot · Impact 0.25–3 · Effort in person-months

Where we override the score The AI analyst scores only 500 (low confidence, high confidence, high effort), but it is our moat, so we test it cheaply first with Wizard-of-Wizard-of-Oz chats. Verification is a Kano basic: it ships regardless.

Meet the AI conversation analyst

It talks with you first, then waits for the right people. Not today, not every Wednesday: the right time.

1 · Talk

A 10-minute chat (text or voice): voice): what you love, how you unwind, what you could talk about about for hours

2 · Understand

An LLM turns the chat into a profile: profile: interests, conversation style, energy. You can see and edit edit it

3 · Score

Hard filters (free windows, area, diet, budget), then a compatibility compatibility score for every possible table

4 · Wait, then seat

Seats you only when a table clears clears the fit threshold, inside your your free windows

An AI PRD specifies uncertainty

Quality precision over recall: a bad table costs more than a missed one

Eval set 200 pilot tables: does the fit score predict the rating?

Guardrails never matches on religion, caste or politics; delete your data anytime

Human fallback our team reviews low-confidence tables

Acceptance + build vs buy

Given I've finished the chat, **when** a table clears the threshold in my windows, **then** I'm invited 48 h ahead, with 2 things we share.

Edge no fit in 21 days → suggest widening area or cuisine

Buy LLM via API · **Build** profile + matching (our moat)

Launch and how we measure it

NORTH STAR
Meals shared / month

Tables that actually happen with 3+ people.

Inputs chat completion · show-up rate · table rating vs AI fit score · 30-day repeat

Guardrails time to first table · safety reports · no-shows

Pilot Gurugram: Cyber Hub and Golf Course Road, 5 partner cafés

Channels Co-working spaces, HR onboarding for new joiners, alumni groups, 'I ate with strangers' reels

Model ₹199 booking fee per seat + commission from restaurants filling weekday tables

Photo · Harshit Katiyar / Unsplash (Gurugram)

The table, as it grows

No one in a new city should eat alone unless they want to.



Now 0–3 months

Wizard-of-Oz pilot: team-run chats, hand matching, 50 tables in Gurugram

Next 3–6 months

AI conversation analyst v1, automated matching, women-only tables

Later 6+ months

AI learns from every rating; regulars tables, corporate new joiners, Bengaluru and Pune

Kill criteria under 30% repeat bookings after 8 weeks of the pilot.

Sources: WHO Commission on Social Connection, 'From loneliness to social connection' (30 Jun 2025) · Ipsos Global Survey on loneliness, India (2021) · OpenTable solo-dining data, Axios (17 Jul 2026) · timeleft.com · The 2026) · timeleft.com · The Week, 'Algorithm on my plate' (Sep 2025) · Course: PM101 sessions 1–6 · Photos: Unsplash (Matt W Newman, Spencer Davis, Harshit Katiyar, Vitaly Gariev)